

“THE ELIMINATION OF HUNGER AND ITS REAL CAUSE, POVERTY, SHOULD BE AT THE TOP OF THE HUMAN AGENDA FOR COMMON ACTION.”

Distinguished origins

Born in Kumbakonam in present-day Tamil Nadu, Monkombu Sambasivan Swaminathan is the son of MK Sambasivan and Parvathi Thangammal. The family was involved in the independence movement, and occasionally played host to Congress leaders, including Gandhi. While Swaminathan’s father had made a name for himself as an excellent and compassionate surgeon, the extended family were agriculturists. Young Swaminathan thus spent his school holidays on his family’s farms in Kerala, which sparked a lasting interest in farming methods and technology.